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Steven Smith led the Washington Freedom to the Major League Cricket (MLC) 2024 title with a commanding 96-run victory over the San Francisco Unicorns in Dallas. Smith, alongside his Australian teammate Glenn Maxwell, excelled with the bat. During the Unicorns' chase, their efforts fell apart as Marco Jansen took charge, claiming three wickets, including both openers.



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Rocky Flintoff, son of former England all-rounder Andrew Flintoff, became the youngest player to score a hundred for the England Under-19s. The 16-year-old's record-breaking score came during the second Youth Men's Test against Sri Lanka in Cheltenham. His 106 from 181 balls helped the visitor set a target of 477 and establish a first-innings lead of 324 runs. The Young Lions went on to win the match by an innings and 53 runs.



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Ireland registered its first-ever home Test win with a hard-fought four-wicket victory over Zimbabwe. The one-off Test took place in Belfast, making Northern Ireland the 23rd country to host a men's Test match. Ireland, which lost half its side for 21 in the second innings, fought back through half-centuries by Lorcan Tucker and Andy McBrine (**above**) to help the host chase down the 158-run total.



REUTERS

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A review of the conduct of the T20 World Cup 2024 will be carried out by ICC after the global body set up a panel. Three of its board directors — Roger Twose, Lawson Naidoo and Imran Khawaja — will oversee the review and submit findings later in the year. It was reported earlier that there was scrutiny on the extent of expenditure on the US leg of the tournament and the organisation of the Caribbean leg. The decision to appoint a review panel was taken at the ICC annual conference in Colombo from July 19 to 22, which was attended by all 108 members. Meanwhile, USA Cricket has appointed Johnathan Atkeison as its new CEO. Atkeison's appointment follows the cricket board being put on notice of suspension by the ICC. This was due to its inability to appoint a full-time CEO and its failure to receive recognition from the United States Olympic and Paralympic Committee (USOPC).